In the book *Chaos*, author Tom O'Neill suggests the LAPD and FBI were prevented from investigating Reeve Whitson due to his status as a federal liaison involved in intelligence operations like Operation CHAOS and COINTELPRO, which granted him significant bureaucratic immunity. Witnesses claimed Whitson's credentials deterred local investigators, and O'Neill found evidence suggesting Whitson's superiors intervened to prevent the Manson Family's jailing after a 1969 raid, ensuring they remained free days after the murders. Evidence O'Neill uncovered suggesting Whitson's proximity to the crime scene includes testimony from Sharon Tate's photographer that Whitson called him 90 minutes before the bodies were found, claims from Whitson's associates that he admitted removing evidence from the house, and the absence of Whitson's name in official reports despite witnesses reporting his foreknowledge to authorities. Read more about the book at Wikipedia.

In *Chaos*, Tom O'Neill provides locations for these figures, placing them in close physical proximity to Charles Manson and the Haight-Ashbury counterculture during the late 1960s.
San Francisco **(1967–1968)**. During the "Summer of Love" and its aftermath, the medical and parole figures were concentrated in the Haight-Ashbury district:

- **Dr. David Smith:** Lived in the Haight-Ashbury district within a mile of the clinic. Specifically, records place his home at **597 Frederick Street** in San Francisco, just blocks from the Haight-Ashbury Free Medical Clinic
- **Dr. Louis Jolyon "Jolly" West:** During the 1966–1967 academic year, West rented a **dilapidated apartment** in the Haight-Ashbury district. He described this residence as a **"laboratory disguised as a hippie crash pad"** where he could observe youths using LSD in their "native habitat."
- **Roger Smith:** As a doctoral researcher and federal parole officer, Smith worked primarily out of an office at the **Haight-Ashbury Free Medical Clinic** at **558 Clayton Street**. O'Neill's research later located him living in Michigan in his retirement.

Los Angeles (1969):
As the Manson Family moved south, the key intelligence and medical figures also relocated to the Los Angeles area:

- **Reeve Whitson:** A mysterious "fixer," Whitson lived in a cabin at the corner of **Laurel Canyon and Lookout Mountain** in Los Angeles. This location placed him at the heart of the Canyon's rock-star community and just miles from the Tate-LaBianca murder sites.
- **Dr. Louis Jolyon "Jolly" West:** In 1969, West moved permanently to Los Angeles to become the chairman of psychiatry at **UCLA**. He lived in a home in Los Angeles (later described as being in the Westwood or Pasadena area in various accounts) until his death in 1999.

Would you like to see a **map-style breakdown** of how close these residences were to **Manson's various homes** (like the Spiral Staircase or Spahn Ranch)?